

COLD FORESTS



One-tenth of the land on Earth, especially in the cold north, is covered in conifers. These tall trees, such as pines and firs, have needles instead of broad leaves and woody cones instead of flowers. They form forests that are home to many birds, from seed-eating siskins to big birds of prey.



The siskin's tail spreads out and acts as a brake.

This Japanese waxwing has a bunch of little feathers, called a crest, on its head.



These feathers are called the alula—they are joined to the bird's thumb.



The feet are stretched out to grab the branch.

Sleeping safely
When birds bend their legs to sit down, or perch, muscles in their legs make their toes curl. Now the bird can't fall off its perch, even if it falls asleep!

Waxwings are named after these red dots—which look like drops of wax.

Ant antics

A Steller's jay gets rid of mites or feather lice by making ants crawl all over its body. The ants get annoyed and squirt out formic acid, which kills the tiny pests!



Angry ants